THE MAURYAN EMPIRE

🧠 High-Yield Fact Table (The Ultimate MCQ Solver) 📌

Term / Name / Book 🏷️	Direct Fact / Detail 📝
Chandragupta Maurya	Founder of the Mauryan Empire in the 4th century BCE; overthrew the Nandas.
Arthashastra	Most important literary source written in Sanskrit; a comprehensive manual on politics, diplomacy, and administration discovered in 1909.
Kautilya	Author of Arthashastra; also known as Vishnugupta and Chanakya; advisor and Prime Minister to Chandragupta.
Indika	Book written by Megasthenes containing impressions of his stay in India.
Megasthenes	Greek ambassador at the court of Chandragupta Maurya; sent by Seleucus Nicator.
Strabo, Arrian, Diodorus	Later Greek authors whose writings contain surviving fragments of the lost original *Indika*.
Armed Women	Normally surrounded the emperor to protect him, according to Megasthenes.
Edicts of Ashoka	The most important, oldest, and best-preserved precisely dated records of India.

Term / Name / Book 🏷️	Direct Fact / Detail 📝
Kharosthi Script	Script written from right to left; used in edicts at Shahbazgarhi and Mansehra.
Brahmi Script	Script written from left to right; used for the rest of Ashoka's edicts.
Bherighosha	The war drum or policy of 'conquest by force'.
Dhammaghosha	The call to non-violence, universal peace, or 'policy of religion'.
Rock Edict-I	Specifically makes reference to the protection of animals and condemns cruel acts.
Sanchi Stupa	Semi-spherical solid dome-like structure made of unburnt bricks and stones, located 45 km from Bhopal in Madhya Pradesh.
Relics	Spiritual body parts of Buddha (hair, teeth, bones) contained in a casket at the base of the stupa dome.
Lion Capital	Sculpture showing four Asiatic lions standing back to back; officially adopted as the Emblem of India in 1950.
Seleucus Nicator	Greek commander defeated by Chandragupta around 305 BCE; gave his daughter Helen in marriage to Chandragupta.

Term / Name / Book 🏷️	Direct Fact / Detail 📝
Pushyagupta	Appointed as the governor of Chandragupta's North-Western province.
Bindusara	Successor to Chandragupta; called a 'slayer of foes' by Greek historian Athenacus; defeated sixteen rulers in South India.
Devanamapriya & Priyadarshi	Titles taken by Ashoka meaning 'The Beloved of the Gods' and 'The Beautiful One' respectively.
Sanghamitra & Mahindra	Ashoka's daughter and son, sent as missionaries to Sri Lanka to propagate Buddhism.
Viharas	Buddhist monasteries where people rested; received donations from Ashoka.

📍 INTRODUCTION & LITERARY SOURCES 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Mauryan empire founded in 4th century BCE by Chandragupta Maurya ➔ organised powerful army and laid foundation of vast empire ➔ overthrew Nandas from Magadha and Greek Satraps from North-West Frontier ➔ unified large part of subcontinent under centralised government ➔ successor Bindusara kept empire intact and extended boundaries ➔ Bindusara's son Ashoka constitutes brightest period in history ➔ after Kalinga War devoted life to human welfare and considered subjects as children ➔ Literary Sources: Arthashastra is most important source written by Kautilya (Vishnugupta/Chanakya) ➔ comprehensive manual in Sanskrit dealing with politics, diplomacy, administration ➔ discovered in 1909 ➔ Indika written by Megasthenes (Greek ambassador sent by Seleucus Nicator) ➔ contains impressions of

stay in India ➔ original Indika lost but fragments survive in writings of Strabo, Arrian, Diodorus ➔ mentions royal processions on golden palanquin, decorated elephants, trained parrots ➔ king surrounded by armed women and never sleeps in same bedroom for two nights. 👑📖

📍 ARCHAEOLOGICAL SOURCES 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Edicts of Ashoka are decree issued by a Sovereign ➔ oldest, best preserved and precisely dated records of India ➔ inscribed on rocks and pillars throughout country ➔ include 14 Major Rock edicts, Seven Pillar edicts, Minor Rock edicts ➔ provide useful insight into life/ideals of Ashoka ➔ edicts at Shahbazgarhi and Mansehra inscribed in Kharosthi script (right to left like Arabic) ➔ rest engraved in Brahmi script (left to right) ➔ most important event was conquest of Kalinga ➔ suffering deeply touched Ashoka's conscience ➔ solemn resolve not to take up arms ➔ war drum (bherighosha) silenced forever ➔ replaced by Dhammaghosha (call to non-violence/universal peace) ➔ prohibited killing animals for sacrifices/consumption (advocated in Rock Edict-I) ➔ Sanchi Stupa is semi-spherical solid dome-like structure of unburnt bricks/stones ➔ represents spiritual body of Buddha containing relics (hair, teeth, bones) in casket at base ➔ laid by Ashoka at Sanchi (45 km from Bhopal, MP) ➔ has four gateways depicting Buddha's life and Jataka stories ➔ symbols like peepal tree, lotus, wheel ➔ pillars surmounted by capitals containing sculptures of lions ➔ Lion Capital shows four Asiatic lions standing back to back ➔ officially adopted as Emblem of India in 1950. 🏛️🦁

📍 THE MAURYAN RULERS (Chandragupta & Bindusara) 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Chandragupta Maurya was founder of Mauryan Empire ➔ dismissed from service of Nandas ➔ met Kautilya (Chanakya) at Takshila who was also wronged by Nandas ➔ joined hands to destroy Nanda dynasty ➔ defeated Nandas at Pataliputra leading to new dynasty

➔ took over territories of Greek ruler Alexander in North-Western India ➔ attacked by Seleucus around 305 BCE ➔ Chandragupta defeated Seleucus and got Kabul, Kandahar, Herat, Baluchistan ➔ Seleucus gave daughter Helen in marriage to Chandragupta ➔ appointed Pushyagupta as governor of North-Western province ➔ empire extended Kabul to Mysore, Bengal to Saurashtra ➔ according to Jain tradition, renounced world after 24 years and handed kingdom to son Bindusara ➔ Bindusara succeeded father ➔ called 'slayer of foes' by Greek historian Athenacus ➔ conquered South India after defeating sixteen rulers ➔ faced revolt in Takshila quelled by second son Ashoka (who was governor there) ➔ maintained friendly relations with Greece. ⚔️🗺️

📍 ASHOKA & AFTERMATH OF KALINGA WAR 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Ashoka succeeded throne after Bindusara's death ➔ took title of 'Devanamapriya' (Beloved of Gods) and 'Priyadarshi' (Beautiful One) ➔ fought famous Kalinga War ➔ Megasthenes noted Kalinga had powerful army (infantry, cavalry, elephants) ➔ Ashoka faced tough resistance but won war ➔ had far reaching consequences ➔ death and destruction brought great change in personal/political life ➔ abandoned 'conquest by force' (bherigosha) for 'policy of religion' (dhammagosha) ➔ stopped hunting and eating meat ➔ prisoners of war used for agricultural work (resulted in economic prosperity) ➔ went on tours to preach Buddhism ➔ sent missionaries to various parts of world ➔ sent daughter Sanghamitra and son Mahindra to Sri Lanka ➔ embraced Buddhism in State Policy (non-violence, disapproval of empty rituals) ➔ erected pillars/edicts to spread teachings ➔ ordered construction of 84,000 stupas ➔ gave donations to Buddhist viharas (where people rested) ➔ abandonment of war led to decline in military preparedness. 🕊️🛕

📍 EXTENT OF EMPIRE & MAURYAN ADMINISTRATION 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**

- After victory at Kalinga, Ashoka's empire extended from Hindukush (north-west) to river Pennar (south) ➔ included Nepal in north and Kabul, Herat, Kandahar outside present boundary of India ➔ Pan-Indian Character: Empire was vast with all-India character ➔ Seleucus handed four provinces (Kabul, Kandahar, Herat, Baluchistan) to Chandragupta ➔ remained with Mauryan empire right up to end of Ashoka's rule ➔ Bindusara established rule over South India ➔ Chandragupta spending last years at Shravanabelagola in Karnataka speaks volumes about Pan-India character ➔ Advantages of Pan-Indian character: (i) marked end of small states ➔ (ii) helped establish trade links with foreign countries ➔ (iii) made India strong to face foreign aggressions successfully ➔ (iv) era of conquests over so Mauryan kings paid more attention to social/economic life of people (all-round economic prosperity). IN 🤝

⏳ NAMES OF KINGS IN CHRONOLOGICAL ORDER 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Sequence:**
  - Chandragupta Maurya ➔ Bindusara ➔ Ashoka ➔ Dasharatha Maurya ➔ Samprati ➔ Brihadratha Maurya. 👑

🧠 High-Yield Fact Table (The Ultimate MCQ Solver) 📌

Term / Role / Province 🏷️	**Direct Fact / Detail** 📝
Paternal Despotism	Nature of Mauryan monarchy under Ashoka ("all men are my children").
Two Main Divisions	Mauryan administration was divided into: Civil Administration & Military Administration.
Civil Administration	Divided into two: Central Government & Provincial Government.

Term / Role / Province 🏷️	Direct Fact / Detail 📝
Mantri Parishad	The council of ministers that assisted the king at the central level.
Purohit	Chief Pujari of the state.
Senapati	Advised the king on matters related to war and peace.
Sannidhata	The head treasurer.
Samaharta	The taxation expert.
Other Important Officers	Accountant General, one in-charge of agriculture, Superintendent of mines, Superintendent of Ports, Controller of Commerce, Superintendent of Weights and Measures.
Magadha	Province with its capital at **Pataliputra**.
Gandhara (North-western)	Province with its capital at **Takshila**.
Avanti (Eastern)	Province with its capital at **Ujjain**.
Southern Province	Province with its capital at **Swarnagiri**.
Kalinga	The newly added 5th province with its capital at **Tosali**.

Term / Role / Province 🏷️	Direct Fact / Detail 📝
Kumar or Aryaputra	Head of a province (only princes were appointed to this position).
Mahamatra	Governors appointed to assist the Kumar and look after the welfare of subjects.
Janapadas	Districts within a province.
Pradeshika	Officer who collected taxes at the district level.
Rajuka	Performed functions of a modern-day Tehsildar or revenue officer.
Yukta	The treasurer at the district level.
Nagaradhyaksha	The head of the city administrative system.
City Committee	A committee of 30 members that looked after the capital city (Pataliputra).
Land Revenue	Chief source of income; fixed at one-sixth to one-fourth of the produce.
Bhaga	Tax levied on agricultural produce and cattle at the rate of one-sixth.
Bali	A religious tribute (according to historians Vincent Smith and Shamashastri).

Term / Role / Province 🏷️	Direct Fact / Detail 📝
Military Commission	A board of 30 members that managed the entire army.
Army Strength	6,00,000 infantry, 30,000 cavalry, 9,000 war-elephants, 8,000 chariots (per Megasthenes/other sources).
Dhamma	A 'Moral Law', 'Common Code of Conduct', or 'Ethical Order' serving as a guideline.

📍 ADMINISTRATION 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Chandragupta Maurya laid foundations of an elaborate system of administration under guidance of Chanakya ➔ Chanakya wrote book 'Arthashastra' in which he describes principles of politics and art of administration ➔ Chandragupta's son Bindusara retained same system ➔ Ashoka made some changes necessitated by change of heart after Kalinga War ➔ (i) Ashoka added new fifth province (Kalinga with Tosali as capital) to existing four provinces ➔ (ii) Mauryan centralised monarchy became a paternal despotism under Ashoka ➔ in one of his Edicts Ashoka says 'all men are my children' ➔ (iii) Ashoka simplified many rigorous practices related to administration regarding taxation and crop collection ➔ this helped increase productivity and economic activity across Empire ➔ (iv) Ashoka appointed Mahamatras (Governors) to look after welfare of his subjects ➔ Mauryan administration had two main divisions: Civil Administration and Military Administration. 🏛️

📍 CIVIL ADMINISTRATION 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**

- The Civil administration had two main divisions ➔ the Central Government and the Provincial Government. ⚖️

📍 (i) CENTRAL GOVERNMENT 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
  - Mauryan government was centralised and managed by several officers of different ranks ➔ king was supreme authority and his throne was hereditary ➔ he was also the supreme judge ➔ Megasthenes (Greek ambassador) in book Indika and Chanakya in Arthashastra tell us about Mauryan administration ➔ Ashoka brought about some changes in administrative system of Chandragupta Maurya ➔ appointed Mahamatras (governors) to look after welfare of his subjects ➔ at central level, king was assisted by council of ministers (Mantri Parishad) headed by Prime Minister ➔ each minister was responsible for his department ➔ council of ministers included chief Pujari of the state called Purohit ➔ Senapati who advised king on matters related to war and peace ➔ head treasurer called Sannidhata ➔ Samaharta the taxation expert ➔ other important officers were Accountant General ➔ one in-charge of agriculture ➔ Superintendent of mines ➔ Superintendent of Ports ➔ Controller of Commerce ➔ as well as Superintendent of Weights and Measures. 👑

📍 (ii) PROVINCIAL GOVERNMENT 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
  - Ashoka made alterations only in central government and not in provincial government ➔ during grandfather's time there were four provinces ➔ after addition of Kalinga in Ashoka's time there were five provinces ➔ Magadha (Capital: Pataliputra) ➔ Gandhara / North-western Province (Capital: Takshila) ➔ Avanti / Eastern Province (Capital: Ujjain) ➔ Southern Province (Capital: Swarnagiri) ➔ Kalinga (Capital: Tosali) ➔ head of province was called Kumar or Aryaputra ➔ only princes were appointed to this position ➔ during Ashoka's time Kumar was assisted by Governor (Mahamatra) ➔ according to some rock and pillar edicts of Ashoka, besides

Mahamatra other officers took active part in administration of provinces. 🗺️

📍 (iii) DISTRICT ADMINISTRATION 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Provinces were divided into districts called Janapadas ➔ their administration was looked after by Pradeshika, Rajuka and Yukta ➔ Pradeshika collected taxes ➔ Rajuka performed functions of modern day Tehsildar or revenue officer ➔ Yukta was the treasurer. 📍

📍 (iv) ADMINISTRATION OF CITIES 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Important cities (capitals of provinces as given earlier) had their own administrative system ➔ head of the city was called Nagaradhyaksha ➔ according to Megasthenes, administration of Pataliputra (capital city of Mauryan empire) was looked after by a committee of 30 members. 🎲

📍 (v) THE REVENUE SYSTEM 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - Land revenue was chief source of income in Mauryan empire ➔ it was one-sixth to one-fourth of the produce ➔ two kinds of taxes namely Bali and Bhaga are mentioned in Edicts of Ashoka ➔ Bhaga was levied on agricultural produce and cattle at rate of one-sixth ➔ according to historians Vincent Smith and Shamashastri, Bali was a religious tribute ➔ toll tax was imposed on articles brought for sale ➔ taxes were levied on liquor shops and gambling houses ➔ some taxes were collected from forests and mines ➔ from revenue collected, state provided various facilities like roads, irrigation, hospitals and met other expenses of state. 💰

📍 (vi) THE SPY SYSTEM 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**

- Chandragupta Maurya had a wide network of spies in his empire ➔ there were spies against spies ➔ and on important matters more than one agent was asked to collect information ➔ king was always kept informed of working of the bureaucracy. 🕵️‍♀️

📍 (vii) MILITARY ADMINISTRATION 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
  - Chandragupta Maurya maintained a huge army consisting of infantry, cavalry, elephants and chariots ➔ according to Megasthenes Mauryan Army consisted of 6,00,000 infantry, 30,000 cavalry, and 9000 war-elephants ➔ according to another source Mauryas maintained 8000 chariots ➔ chief weapons used were bows, arrows, shields, swords, etc. ➔ king was commander-in-chief of army ➔ whole army was under military commission of thirty members ➔ Mauryas also had well-laid recruitment policy ➔ soldiers were paid salary in cash ➔ Mauryan king had built forts at strategic places for safety and security of the empire. 🛡️

📍 ASHOKA'S DHAMMA 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
  - After Kalinga war Ashoka became people's king ➔ embraced Buddhism but did not impose it on his subjects ➔ wanted subjects to follow such a Dhamma that may be based on unifying principles of all major religions of the world ➔ Dhamma as described in Ashoka's Edicts is not a religion or religious system ➔ but a 'Moral Law', a 'Common Code of Conduct' or an 'Ethical Order' ➔ which is a common meeting ground (guideline) of all religions. ☸️

📍 PRINCIPLES OF DHAMMA 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
  - Ashoka's Dhamma has the following salient points: (i) Respect for elders and love for children ➔ (ii) Ahimsa or non-violence ➔ (iii) Good deeds or good karma would give happiness to man in next birth ➔ (iv) He taught people to respect all religions ➔ (v) He disapproved empty rituals. 🕊️

📍 IMPACT OF DHAMMA ON ASHOKA'S IMPERIAL POLICY 📌

- 🗺️➡️ **The Ultimate Revision Flow Chart:**
    - (i) Religious unity: People belonging to different religions followed their emperor's policy of religious tolerance ➔ (ii) Moral values: People under influence of Dhamma started living a moral life ➔ (iii) End of crimes: Policy of Ahimsa did have great moral impact on people ➔ thefts, crimes and other such activities almost came to an end ➔ (iv) Public welfare: With policy of conquests and wars having come to an end, Ashoka's Dhamma helped officials to undertake public welfare and public work schemes ➔ this resulted in prosperity and helped people to lead a peaceful life. ✨